

DILLARD DRIVE MAGNET ELEMENTARY

Science Olympiad

Parent Information Session

Monday, September 14, 2026 · Grades 3–6 · Tournament: Sat, March 13, 2027



Think track team, not science fair.

Students pair up, each take on a few science events, and spend the year getting good at them. In March we compete against other elementary schools. Everyone has their own event, and every score counts toward the team.



Written events

Identify rocks, insects, sea life, storms. Study, then show what you know.



Built events

Pasta bridges, rubber-powered planes, egg rockets, foil barges. Design, test, rebuild.



Thinking events

Ciphers, circuits, technical writing, science drawing. Solve and explain.

Fifteen events.

Build & Test

Bridge-A-Roni

A pasta bridge that holds the most weight

Egg-O-Naut

A rocket that lands a raw egg safely

Just Plane Awesome

A rubber-powered plane, longest flight wins

Ship Shape

A foil barge that carries the most cargo

Beam Me Up

Bounce light off mirrors to hit a target

Field & Specimen

Buzzworthy

Insects: body parts, habitats, life cycles

Deep Blue Sea

Ocean zones and how sea creatures adapt

Geology Rocks!

Rocks, minerals, and the rock cycle

Roots & Reptiles

Plants, reptiles, and NC state symbols

Storm Chasers

Severe weather and how it changes the land

Diagram & Decode

Codebusters

Crack coded messages using ciphers

Describe It, Build It

Write instructions a partner builds from

Science Sketchers

Draw science ideas for teammates to guess

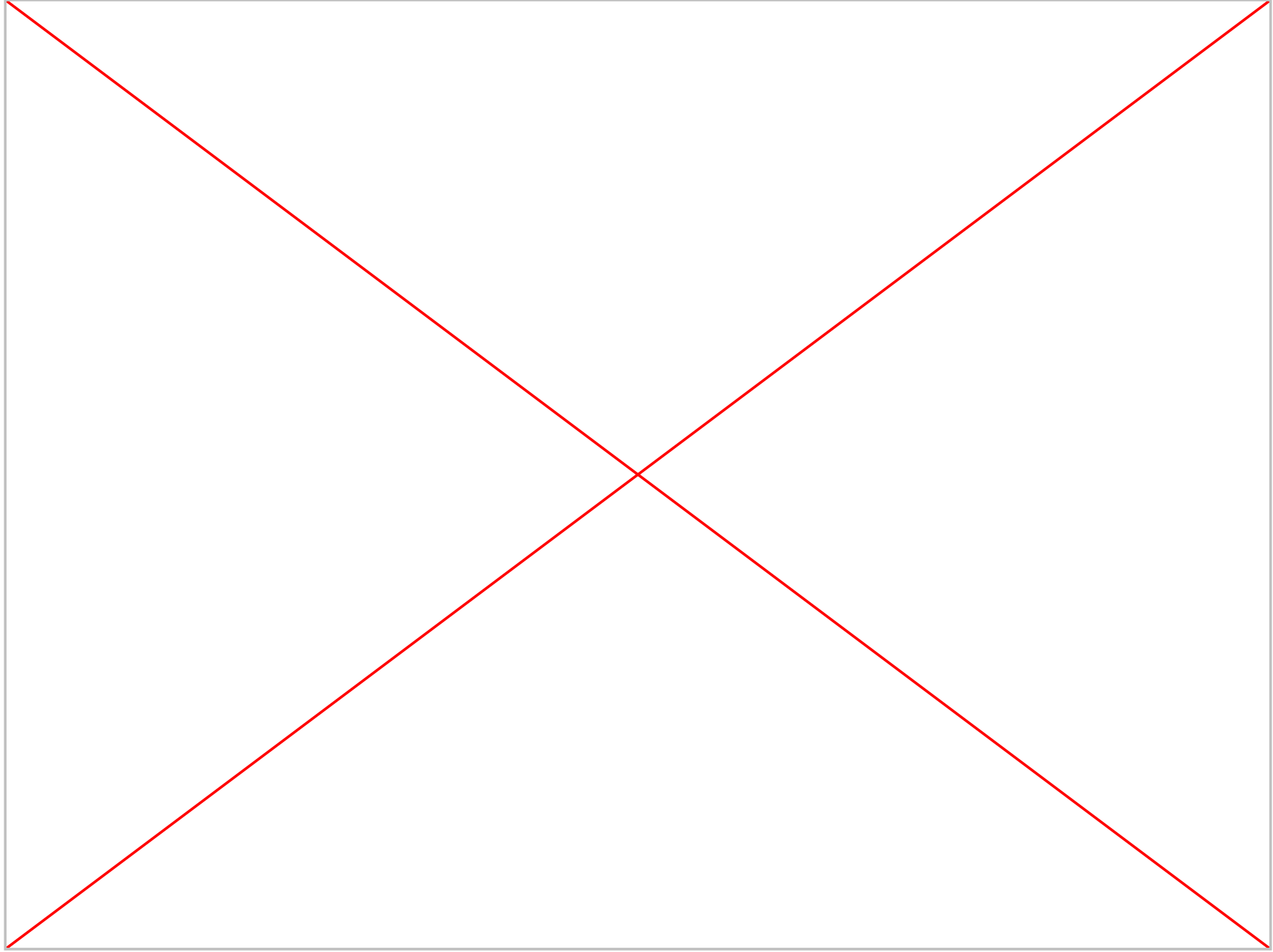
Zap Lab

Circuits, conductors, and how electricity works

Pump It Up

The heart, lungs, and how they work together

Every student competes in two or three events. Full rules are [here](#).





How event assignments will be determined

1

The tournament schedule



2

Their interests
(from the interest form)



3

Their skills (observe on Friday)



4

Their effort
(completion of the
take-home assignment)



What we ask of students.

45 min

Fridays after school

4:15 to 5:00, starting September 25.
This is the whole in-person
commitment most weeks.

20–30 min

At home, each week

One small, specific task. Bring three
rocks you can name. Build a tower
and measure it.

A few

Saturday build sessions

Optional, and only for students on
Bridge & Egg-O-Naut.

The at-home half is the part that matters most. We meet once a week, which is not enough time on its own. The students who practice at home are the ones who feel ready in March.

This is *our* team.

Science Olympiad at Dillard Drive is parent-run. It exists because families decide to build it.

And that is the best part! Our team gets to look like whatever we decide to make it.

Kate Kremer

Volunteer Coach

Suzy Krutsch

Staff Coach, AIG Teacher

You

Any and all help is encouraged!

Event Parent

About 2 hours a month

Own one or two events for the season. Learn the rules, prep the materials, and run that station on rotation weeks. No special science experience needed:

<https://ncscienceolympiad.ncsu.edu/resources/elementary/>

Theme Lead

About 3 hours a month

Coordinate the Event Parents for one of the three groups: Build, Field, or Decode. Coordinate & plan experiences.

Build Saturday Crew

About 4 Saturdays

Help with bridges, rockets, and planes. Hot glue, measuring, and keeping a room full of kids on task.

Co-Coach(es)

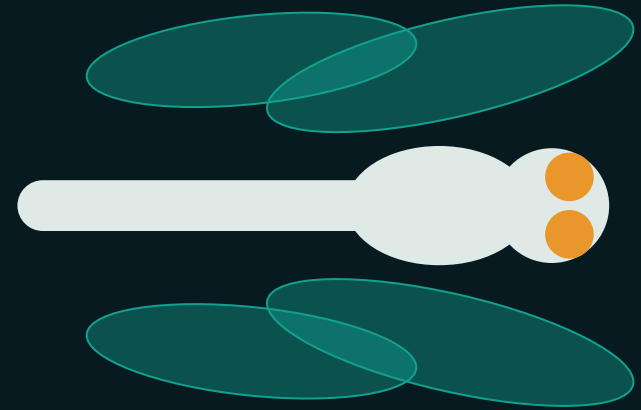
Help with overall organization & coordination, cover for events that don't have an event parent, parent communication, prepare to carry on the team next year

Dates to put on the fridge.

By Sun, Sept 20	Interest form due, 9:00 PM	Link on the website. It takes four minutes. Please don't leave it for later.
Fri, Sept 25	First student meeting	4:15 to 5:00 at school. Everyone comes. Students bring their take-home task.
Fri, Oct 2	Regular rotation schedule begins	Full season calendar and your student's event assignments will go out prior to this date.
Fri, Oct 30	Team Check-In	Tell us by this date if something isn't working. After this, rosters are final.
Sat, Mar 13	Chatham Regional Tournament	Seaforth High School. The whole point of the year. Save the date now.

Your Next Steps:

- 1 Fill out the [interest form](#) by 9 PM Sunday, Sept 20.
- 2 Give your student the [take-home task](#). They bring it September 25.



k8kremer.github.io/ddmes-scioly

Kate Kremer · katrinakremer@gmail.com